

Food Court Tycoon — Visual Polish Brief

For a Claude design session · August 2026 · The game is feature-complete, 255 tests green, publishing soon. This pass is pure visual craft.

Read this first: how this project does art

You cannot ship images. No PNGs, no SVG assets, no bundled files. Every piece of art in this game is **programmatically SwiftUI vector code** — Canvas, Path, shapes, and gradients drawn in Swift. That is not a limitation to work around; it is the pipeline. All existing art was built this way and yours will be too.

- **Repo:** the session opens in the project root. Art lives in `Sources/UI/Art/`; theme tokens in `Sources/UI/Theme.swift`.
- **Foundation already shipped:** `Theme.topLight` / `Theme.buttonLight` / `Theme.edgeLight` (top-lit material overlays), glowing-bulb helper `glowDot` in `VenueProps.swift`, a shared sheen pass in `FoodSprite.swift`, stage light-pool and vignette in `VenueStageView.swift`. Build on these — do not reinvent or duplicate them.
- **Verify visually, every surface:** build to the iPhone 17 Pro Max simulator (`xcodebuild -project Fable.xcodeproj -scheme Fable -destination 'platform=iOS Simulator,name=iPhone 17 Pro Max' build-for-testing`, then `xcrun simctl install/launch, screenshot` with `xcrun simctl io booted screenshot`). Compare before/after; iterate until it clearly reads richer. One surface per commit.
- **Never break:** the full test suite (run `test-without-building` before each commit — must stay at 255 green, 11 StoreKit skips expected on CLI); accessibility labels; `accessibilityReduceMotion` fallbacks for every animation; allocation-free per-frame work (the engine ticks at 20 Hz with `TimelineView` interpolation on top); dark-theme-first (the game forces dark mode). `xcodegen generate` if you add any file.
- **The look:** flat-vector arcade charm, dark purple-ink chrome (`Theme.ink #1C1622`, panels `#241D2E`), gold coin `#F5C242`, cyan gem `#5BD6E8`. The refresh direction is *depth and life*, never realism: soft top-light, glow, motion — keep the friendly outlines.

The work, in priority order

1 · Bespoke props for the two twist venues — `Sources/UI/Art/VenueProps.swift`

The Midnight Diner currently borrows the burger set and the Food Truck Rally borrows the taco set (case labels `.burger`, `.diner` and `.taco`, `.foodtruck` — split them). Diner: neon script sign with a real glow (reuse `glowDot`'s halo trick on stroked paths), venetian-blind window with moonlight slats, a glowing pie case, wall clock at 2 AM. Food Truck Rally: two parked trucks with striped awnings, pennant strings, a chalkboard "TODAY'S SPECIAL" easel (the venue's x3 rotating-special mechanic deserves its landmark), thin smoke wisp from a truck vent. Palettes already exist in `Theme.swift` (`.diner` midnight blue/neon pink, `.foodtruck` sunset rust/teal).

2 · The Gold Spatula, and real tool drawings — `CollectionView.swift` (`toolShelf`), new drawings in `Sources/UI/Art/`

The seven Kitchen Tools currently render as `GlyphIcon` placeholders. Draw each as a small bespoke vector (wooden spoon, egg timer, copper pan, ladle, chef's knife, whisk, **gold spatula**). The Gold Spatula is the rarest item in the game and the single most important drawing in this brief: give it a gleam sweep (a moving specular highlight, `TimelineView`-driven, static fallback under reduced motion) and make its drop celebration (`BigMomentAlertView` via `RootView` case `.toolDrop`) feel like the game's crown jewel — gold star-burst backdrop, slow rotate-in. Unfound tools on the shelf stay dark silhouettes of the same drawings.

3 · Characters — `Sources/UI/Art/CustomerSprite.swift`

Paper-doll geometric figures today: rectangle torso, circle head, no hands. Better silhouettes

(necks, shoulders, mitt-hands), venue-themed uniform accents (diner waitress cap, taco vendor apron...), and a 2–3 keyframe idle bob + occasional blink. Queue customers in `VenueStageView` should shuffle-step rather than teleport. Polish the rarity portrait frames so Legendary genuinely glitters (animated shimmer stroke, reduced-motion static).

4 • Food with dimension — `Sources/UI/Art/FoodSprite.swift`

A shared sheen/shade pass already overlays every sprite; go further per-item: gradient fills on the big shapes, a crisp specular dot, serving context (fry basket weave, cup lid + straw highlight, plate rim). Keep one consistent viewing angle across the whole set. ~40 drawings share the `FoodArt` case system — batch by shape family.

5 • The prestige moment — `Sources/UI/RootView.swift` (`runRecap`), `Sources/UI/VenueStageView.swift`, `Sources/UI/Art/CoinBurst.swift`

Franchising is the biggest decision in the game and deserves the biggest picture: a full-screen star-field beat behind the run-recap sheet (drifting gold stars on ink, Canvas-drawn). Then permanent status: at 5 / 15 / 40 total franchises the venue's hanging sign gains bronze / silver / gold trim (`VenueSignFrame` in the stage; read `engine.state.prestigeCount`). Payout numbers from `CoinBurstView` should pop-scale then drift with a slight arc.

6 • Event-surface identity — `Sources/UI/Sheets/EventsView.swift`

The Weekly Gauntlet card wants urgency: a stopwatch emblem, a red sweep-hand tick while a sprint is live, the live score in a punched-up ticker treatment. The season-twist card wants a small wand-sparkle emblem. Keep both inside the existing card layouts — this is dressing, not restructuring.

7 • Picker emblems — `Sources/UI/Sheets/ChoiceSheetView.swift`

Contract and Legacy-perk options use SF Symbols in plain circles. Draw small vector emblems instead: a wax-sealed contract scroll motif for contracts (each option tinted by its personality — flame for High Roller, moon for Night Owl), a small tree-of-rings motif for Legacy perks. These are the two most consequential choices in the game; their pickers should look like it.

8 • Chrome identity — `Sources/UI/RootView.swift` (`BottomBar`), `Sources/UI/HUDView.swift`

Tab-bar icons: a true bespoke five-icon set with a distinct active state (filled + under-glow, not just tint). HUD pills: metallic gradient on the coin pill, crystalline facets on the gem pill, warm glow on the star pill when `pendingStars > 0` (the "+N ready" anticipation state).

9 • App icon + launch screen — `Sources/UI/Art/Icons.swift`, `launch screen view`

Last, so they inherit the refreshed language: the icon should read at 60 px (suggest: the gold spatula crossed over a burger, ink background, gold rim). Launch screen matches.

Celebration hierarchy (respect it)

Tier

Moments

Treatment

Ultra

Gold Spatula drop • first Franchise

full-screen beat, star-burst, biggest fanfare

Major

run recap • Legacy level • legendary manager • landmark crossings

moment sheet or big confetti

Standard

quest/catering claims • perk pick • tier claims

confetti burst + chime (exists)

Ambient

serves, taps, combos

pooled number pops, ring glow

Nothing below its tier may out-celebrate the tier above — if everything sparkles, nothing does.

Don'ts

- Don't restructure layouts, copy, or mechanics — this brief is paint, light, and motion only.
- Don't add image assets of any kind, or third-party dependencies.
- Don't animate anything continuously that the player isn't looking at; gate ambient work on view visibility.
- Don't touch Sources/Core/ except read-only (one exception: none — if a hook seems missing, note it in your report instead).
- Don't ship any surface without a before/after screenshot comparison in your final report.

End of brief. Work top to bottom; if the session runs short, items 1–5 are the ones the game most visibly lacks today.